

Five books that will change how you think.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 02, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/fDEJE5s0xvk> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter recommends five books that transformed his thinking on stoicism, marketing segmentation, power dynamics, negotiation, and the relentless pursuit of extreme success.

Contents

-  Book 1: Meditations by Marcus Aurelius
-  Book 2: Breakthrough Advertising
-  Book 3: The 48 Laws of Power
-  Book 4: Never Split the Difference
-  Book 5: Relentless by Tim Grover

Book 1: Meditations by Marcus Aurelius 0:00

- Core lesson: emotional control
 - Brandon cites this as the primary takeaway — managing your reactions and inner state

Book 2: Breakthrough Advertising 0:05

- Core lesson: how to market to different segments of people
- Notable detail: the book costs approximately **\$200 on Amazon**, signaling its cult/rare status among marketers

Book 3: The 48 Laws of Power 0:10

- Core lesson: understanding power dynamics — offensive and defensive
- Addresses the common criticism that the book is "evil"
 - Brandon reframes it: "It's not instructions. It's almost like a warning."
 - Primary value: recognizing when others are using these tactics *against* you, so you can shield yourself

Book 4: Never Split the Difference by Chris Voss 0:20

- Core lesson: negotiation
- Brandon calls it "probably the best book when it comes to negotiating"

Book 5: Relentless by Tim Grover 0:24

- Core lesson: what it truly takes to pursue extreme success
- Personal significance: Brandon liked it so much he **got it tattooed on him**
- Key insight: the level of intensity required for extreme success was greater than he had anticipated

"I like this book so much I got it tattooed on me. It really showed me what it takes to go after extreme success and it's a lot more intense than maybe I thought."